Effective Date:
10/01/2023

Background:
The COLA adjustments are effective every year on the **first day of October**. For Semi-Annual Reporting (SAR) households (HH) where October falls mid-period, the COLA is treated as a county initiated mid period change.

Purpose:
This notice provides staff with an overview of the COLA changes and instructions for implementation.

Policy:
The COLA mass update ran from August 26 through 31, 2023. The Scratch Budget has been updated to reflect the new amounts. The following changes are part of the FFY 2024 COLA:

Item	Change
Maximum Allotments	Increased and can be found on the Assistance Standards Tables (63-1101)
Minimum Allotment	Remains $23 for a HH of 1 or 2
Income Eligibility Standards	Increased and can be found on the Assistance Standards Tables
Shelter Deduction	Increased from $624 to $672
Standard Deduction	Increased as follows: **Eligible HH Size** / **Standard Deduction** 1-3 / $198 4 / 208 5 / 244 6 or more / 279
Homeless HH Shelter Allowance	Increased from $166.81 to $179.66
Standard Utility Allowance (SUA)	Increased from $560 to $596
Limited Utility Allowance (LUA)	Increased from $150 to $158
Telephone Utility Allowance (TUA)	Increased from $18 to $19

The following resource limits will remain the same as part of the FFY 2024 COLA:

- $4,250 for HH that include an elderly or disabled (E/D) member, and
- $2,750 for all other HHs.

Notices:
Timely notice is not required when processing a mass change. The Notice to All CalFresh Recipients (CF 11) is available in the Electronic Forms Library (EFL) for customers that have questions about COLA.

COLA informing posters are required to be displayed in areas frequented by customers at Family Resource Centers (FRCs). Posters must remain on display from October 1, 2023, until November 30, 2023. The COLA informing posters are attached to this letter.

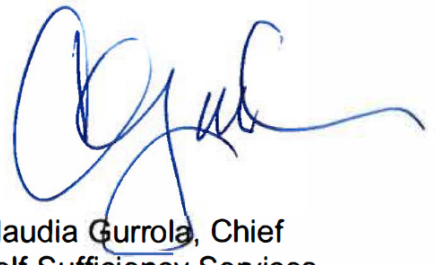
Management Reporting:
The following COLA Supplemental Reports require action and can be found on the Self-Sufficiency Services Tracking SharePoint:

Report	Content	Action Required
List of Cases Discontinued by Batch Eligibility Determination Benefit Calculation (EDBC) Process.	Description of changes or ongoing data collection which were not yet processed through EDBC.	Review the case and verify if the discontinuance is valid.
List of Cases Where Batch EDBC Process Closed a Person.	Description of changes or ongoing data collection which were not yet processed through EDBC.	Review the case and verify if the discontinuance is valid.
List of Cases That Resulted in Read-Only EDBC.	Batch EDBC could not automatically apply the intended change to these cases.	Process EDBC to apply intended changes, if applicable.
List of Cases Skipped in Batch Run.	Batch EDBC could not automatically apply the intended change to these cases.	Process EDBC to apply intended changes if applicable. Reminder: When processing EDBC on these cases, remember to run for both CalWORKs and CalFresh.
List of Cases with at Least One Overridden EDBC for COLA Months.	CalFresh cases that meet the following criteria: • At least one overridden EDBC effective for the current or prior benefit month. • Batch EDBC is run for the COLA Month • Program is CalFresh, CalWORKs, RCA or Nutritional Benefit The case information will display only once on the list even if more than one month may be impacted.	Review these cases and take action, as needed.
Batch Eligibility Report CalFresh-CalWORKs - 09-06-23.	Cases which could not be processed.	Review these cases and take action, as needed.

References:
All County Information Notice I-48-23
All County Letter 23-48
MPP 63-1100 Eligibility Determination
Scratch Budget – Eligibility Operations Desk Aid
Management Reports – Self-Sufficiency Services Tracking SharePoint

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 09/30/2024.

Approval for Release:



Claudia Gurrola, Chief
Self-Sufficiency Services